

FREE CHECKLIST

POD Legal Checklist: 7 Steps to Build Your Business Right

Most POD courses start at your Etsy storefront. This checklist starts where they should have. Before you design a single product, these seven steps protect you legally, financially, and at tax time.

1

Choose Your Business Structure — Recommended: LLC

An LLC separates your personal assets from your business. If something goes wrong — a dispute, a copyright claim, a tax problem — your personal bank account and home are not in play. Operating as a sole proprietor means everything is in play.

Cost: \$50–\$500 depending on state | Time: ~20 min online | Where: Your state's Secretary of State website

2

File Your Articles of Organization

This is the official document that creates your LLC. File with your state's Secretary of State office online. You will need your LLC name (check availability first), registered agent name and address, principal business address, and the filing fee.

Once approved, keep the approval document — you need it to open a business bank account.

3

Get Your EIN from the IRS (Free, 10 Minutes)

An EIN is your business tax ID. You need it instead of your SSN on Etsy tax forms, to open a business bank account, and to keep your personal SSN off business documents.

Cost: Free | Time: 10 min | Where: IRS.gov — search "Apply for EIN Online" | Note: This is not tax advice. Consult a licensed CPA for your situation.

4

Open a Dedicated Business Checking Account

Every dollar in from Etsy goes into this account. Every dollar out — Printify charges, Canva, supplies — comes out of this account. Nothing else. Bring your LLC approval document, EIN confirmation, photo ID, and initial deposit.

Many business accounts have no minimum deposit — check credit unions and online banks.

5

Register Your Etsy Shop Under Your LLC

Use your business email address when opening your Etsy shop. In Etsy tax settings: Account → Billing → Tax Information → enter your EIN, not your Social Security number.

Do this before your first sale.

6

Set Up Basic Bookkeeping Before Your First Sale

You do not need a bookkeeper on day one. You need a system. Recommended: QuickBooks Simple Start (~\$17.50/month) connected to your business bank account. Categorize Etsy payouts as revenue, Printify charges as cost of goods, platform fees as expenses. Spend 30 minutes per month keeping it current.

Note: This is not tax advice. Consult a licensed CPA for your situation.

7

Understand Your Self-Employment Tax Obligation

If your POD business earns more than \$400 net profit in a year, you owe self-employment tax (15.3%) plus regular income tax — not withheld automatically. Pay quarterly: April 15, June 15, September 15, January 15 via IRS Direct Pay at IRS.gov.

Rule of thumb: Set aside 25–30% of every Etsy payout into a savings account earmarked for taxes. | Note: This is not tax advice. Consult a licensed CPA for your situation.

The Legit Launch is operated by Aspect Media Holdings, LLC. This checklist is for general informational purposes only. It does not constitute legal or tax advice. Consult a licensed attorney for legal questions specific to your state and situation. Consult a licensed CPA or tax professional for tax questions specific to your business.

Want the full course? Join the waitlist at thelegitlaunch.com — waitlist members get early-bird pricing.

© 2026 Aspect Media Holdings, LLC